

CASE CONSILIUM - 2026

PROBLEM STATEMENT

PRESENTED BY



EP BIOCOMPOSITES LTD
Contributing to a Clean, Green & Safe Planet



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BACKGROUND

EP Biocomposites Limited (EPBL), part of the EP Kamat Group, is a Goa based, BSE SME listed manufacturer and one of India's sole Transfer of Technology (ToT) holders for DRDO certified bio digester sanitation technology. Founded in 1991, the group has built over three decades of manufacturing credibility. Its bio digester toilets are an alternative to conventional septic tanks, using inoculum bacteria to break down human waste anaerobically. The process deactivates 99% of pathogens with no sludge accumulation and no bad odour, and the only by-products are water suitable for gardening or other non-potable reuse, plus odourless gas.

EPBL also offers Sewage and Effluent Treatment Plants (STP/ETP), along with FRP based advanced modular STP technologies and ozone based oxy-STP. It provides standard modular units for apartments, housing colonies, hotels and customised ETPs for hospitals and industries. EPBL has executed institutional projects including the Hubli Smart City Unkal Nullah wetland project and sanitation-related projects with organisations such as ONGC and Government of Goa.

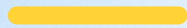
FY26 revenue came in at around ₹11.7 crore, with net profit of around ₹0.92 crore. Net worth crossed ₹12 crore as of 31 March 2026, with ROI of about 14% and ROCE of about 16% for the year. IPO proceeds have been directed toward capacity expansion, working capital, and partial debt repayment. In February 2026, EPBL signed an MoU with IISc Bengaluru for technical consultancy on non-biological wastewater recycling R&D exploring technologies beyond its current bio digester base.

INDUSTRY OVERVIEW

Decentralised sanitation is the part of India's wastewater management sector that serves locations where conventional sewerage is unavailable, uneconomical, or unable to keep pace with development. Tier 2 and Tier 3 urbanisation has expanded this need across residential, hospitality, educational, commercial and institutional developments. Unlike municipal sanitation, this segment is privately funded. Developers, businesses, institutions and individual property owners pay for and operate their own infrastructure, either through direct procurement or CSR eligible spending, since sanitation and safe drinking water are recognised Schedule VII CSR activities under the Companies Act.

A few structural tailwinds are worth noting: construction activity spreading beyond metros, tightening environmental compliance, groundwater contamination risk from poorly maintained septic systems, and a growing preference for maintenance free, sludge free on site treatment. EPBL's bio digester systems are typically configured for 700 to 15,000 litre applications and STP projects range from 5 Kilo Litres per Day (KLD) to Million Litres per Day (MLD) which makes them most relevant to properties without a municipal sewer connection.

CORE PROBLEM



With rising urbanisation, inadequate sewerage connectivity, and growing private demand for decentralised sanitation, EPBL's leadership wants to expand its bio digester toilet and wastewater treatment business into the non government, private pay market across Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities of Goa, Maharashtra and Karnataka. The strategic tension is this: EPBL's current customer base, price points (₹30,000 to ₹10 lakh for bio digesters, ₹5 lakhs to ₹2.5 crore for STP related wastewater projects), and trust building approach were built around individual homeowners and institutional or government relationships. The private market spans a much wider range of buyers, including hospitality, residential and commercial developers, industrial and hospital operators, and CSR funded institutions, along with different funding mechanisms and procurement behaviours that EPBL has to systematically navigate.

Direction for participants: focus exclusively on bio digester toilets and wastewater/STP ETP opportunities, not other product lines. As part of your analysis, research which competitors are active in decentralised bio digester and wastewater treatment in this market, and what technologies they're using. This should inform your positioning and portfolio recommendations.

DELIVERABLES

1. Customer Segmentation and Targeting

Segment EPBL's non-government buyer base for bio digester toilets and wastewater/STP ETP solutions across Tier 2 and Tier 3 towns in Goa, Maharashtra, and Karnataka. Identify the distinct buyer archetypes, then prioritise the three most attractive personas to pursue. For each, define how they discover EPBL, who the actual decision maker is, the price point they'll bear, and the specific strategy to onboard them.

2. Market Opportunity and Go to Market Roadmap

Size the addressable market for bio digester toilets and decentralised wastewater treatment among non-government buyers in these geographies, and quantify the revenue opportunity for EPBL. State your sizing approach and assumptions explicitly. Translate this into a three-year go to market strategy, structured as a phase wise roadmap, specifying which states, city tiers, and customer segments each phase targets, and the KPIs that mark progression from one phase to the next.

3. Risk Assessment and Mitigation Framework

Identify the principal risks EPBL faces in this market entry, across four required dimensions: competitive, distribution/channel, financial, and operational, plus one additional risk category of your choice if material. For each risk, propose a concrete mitigation plan.

4. Portfolio Expansion: Adjacent Products and Technologies

Recommend adjacent sanitation and wastewater/resource recovery technologies EPBL should develop, license, manufacture, or distribute, building on its existing bio digester and STP/ETP capabilities. Evaluate each option against market demand, technical feasibility, capital required, project scale, operational complexity, margin profile, and synergy with EPBL's current capabilities, and identify the strongest candidates to diversify EPBL's revenue base within sanitation and wastewater.

EVALUATION CRITERIA

1. Quality and Depth of Analysis
2. Creativity
3. Feasibility of the Solution
4. The Overall Presentation of the case

SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

1. Teams have to prepare a **5-slider deck** (excluding the cover page, references, glossary, executive summary, etc.) explaining their solutions to the deliverables mentioned in the previous section.
2. The submission must be uploaded on the Unstop Portal by **9 September 2026, 23:59 PM**. Late submissions will not be entertained.
3. Submissions must only be in PDF format, and the file must strictly adhere to the following naming convention: "**CaseConsilium_teamname**"
4. The maximum PDF size is 50 MB.
5. Teams are also requested to submit a **short video**, featuring either the entire team or one/more team members, sharing their experience solving EP Biocomposites' Problem Statement, their key learnings from the case, how the experience challenged their thinking, how it helped them approach a real-world business problem
Video Format accepted: .mp4
Maximum video size allowed: 50 MB
Time Limit: 60 to 90 seconds

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